Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

Zurich, Switzerland zijlstra.thomas@gmail.com

https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ https://tzijlstra-acn.github.io/CV/

Languages: English · German · Dutch

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI commercialization and financial-services professional with 10+ years of experience. Investment banking background until March 2020, spanning Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale and direct investment and financing at a single family office. Since 2020, enterprise AI and digital transformation at Accenture across regulated financial-services clients. Combines commercial judgment, executive stakeholder management, regulated-industry expertise, and working technical capability across agentic workflows, integrations, AI economics, and human-control design.

EXPERIENCE

Accenture, Zurich

Mar 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy for a large Swiss insurer.
- Stream leadership for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB.
- AI architecture and economics work.
- Developed and implemented AI-agent workflows for RCSA and third-party risk management.
- Coordination across business, risk, data, technology, governance, and senior stakeholders.

Single Family Office, Prior to Accenture

Aug 2018 – Mar 2020

Investment & Finance Manager

- Company valuation and cash-flow modelling.
- Direct-investment and financing analysis.
- Debt, asset-backed, and equity-financing discussions.
- Engagement with investors, portfolio companies, and financing counterparties.
- Work in an entrepreneurial growth environment.

Société Générale, London

Jun 2015 – Jul 2018

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG — DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

Catalina, Paris

Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

- Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.
- Statistical analysis of transaction data.
- Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.
- Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

- An enterprise-oriented platform combining multiple specialized agent workflows, a knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approvals, enterprise integration patterns, and an MCP layer.
- Commercial relevance: Shows how isolated AI use cases can become a reusable platform and expansion path rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 Control Line

Public compliance demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

- A staged workflow connecting a regulatory requirement to control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy verification, compliance documentation, human approval, and an evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: Turns an abstract regulatory requirement into a bounded, measurable workflow suitable for a paid design partnership.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · any efficiency estimate is illustrative, not a measured client result

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

- An interactive cost and scenario tool for estimating the economics of a shared enterprise AI platform, covering industry assumptions, model routing, cloud/sovereign/on-premise scenarios, and cost-vs-gain projections.
- Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the ability to translate technical architecture into buyer-facing economics and proposal content.
- Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder

CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments

2014 – 2015

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Cum laude · 8.5/10

Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration

2011 – 2014

Rotterdam School of Management

Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery · commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts

LANGUAGES

English · German · Dutch